Focus States

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

Focus states occur when we focus on an interactive element. Interactive elements include links, buttons, and input fields. You can focus on an element by clicking it (if the click doesn't take you somewhere else), or by pressing the ‘Tab’ key until the element is selected.

Focus states have their own WCAG rules. The focus indicator must be visible, have a contrast ratio of at least 3:1 against nearby colours, and not be completely hidden by sticky headers or other content.

How to support it

If you're building or designing a new component, make sure its focus state meets all three of these rules.

Useful Links

Understanding focus state styles
Wise - Focus states
Focusing on focus states